ZIMBABWE ELECTORAL COMMISSION

Report on

Ward 14 of Chinhoyi Municipality and

Ward 6 of Epworth Local Board

By-Elections Held on 2nd August 2025

Executive Summary

1. The Zimbabwe Electoral Commission (ZEC) is an Election Management Body (EMB) established in terms of Section 238 of the Constitution of Zimbabwe.

2. Its functions are provided for in *Section 239* of the said Constitution.

3. Following the notification of the local authority vacancies which arose in Ward 14 of Chinhoyi Municipality and Ward 6 of Epworth Local Board, the Commission issued **ZEC Notices on 1 and 31 July 2025** respectively calling for by-elections to be held.

4. The by-elections were held on 2 August 2025

5. The Commission incurred expenses amounting to ZWG 12 000 000 for the by-elections.

6. The Commission conducted voter education exercises for the pre-nomination and pre-polling phases. The key messages for pre-nomination voter education focused on what caused the by-elections and the qualifications for aspiring candidates. The pre-polling key messages focused on the information on how to vote.

7. The Nomination Courts to receive nomination papers for aspiring candidates to stand for election as Councillors in Ward 14 of Chinhoyi Municipality and Ward 6 of Epworth Local Board sat on the 3rd and 30th of June 2025 respectively.

   At the close of the sitting of the nomination courts the results were as follows:

Local Authority Candidates

Local Authority	Ward	Candidate	Sex	Sponsoring Party
Chinhoyi Municipality	14	Solomon Bizwork	M	ZANU PF
		Zimbiri Hope	M	Independent
Epworth Local Board	6	Bushe Civilised	M	ZANU PF
		Nyahunzvi Alice	F	MDC-T
		Nyapetwa Peter	M	Independent

8. A total of seventeen thousand seven hundred and fifty (17 750) ballot papers were printed for the local authority by-elections. This information was publicised in terms of the law.

9. The Commission established twenty-five (25) polling stations for voting purposes. This information was publicised in terms of the law.

10. The Commission used its own fleet of vehicles for the by-elections.

11. The training of electoral officers was conducted from 22 to 31 July 2025.

12. There Commission received an application for the accreditation of observers.

13. The by-elections for Ward 14 Chinhoyi Municipality and Ward 6 Epworth Local Board were held on 2 August 2025 and results were announced on the same day.

14. Below is a Schedule of local authority candidates that were declared winners after the polls.

Local Authority	**Ward**	**Winner**	**Sex**	**Party**
Chinhoyi Municipality	14	Solomon Bizwork	M	ZANU PF
Epworth Local Board	6	Bushe Civilised	M	ZANU PF

15. The 2 August 2025 by-elections were held under peaceful conditions and no cases of politically motivated disturbances were received by the Commission.

TABLE OF CONTENTS

Chapter 1 5

1.1 THE ZIMBABWE ELECTORAL COMMISSION 5

1.2 Composition 5

Chapter 2 8

2.1 BUDGET 8

2.2 Budget Control 8

Chapter 3 9

3.1 PREPARATIONS FOR THE BY-ELECTIONS 9

3.2 Voter Education 9

3.3 Nomination Court Results 9

3.4 Voter Registration 10

3.5 Provision of voters rolls to Candidates 10

3.6 Multiparty Liaison Committees 10

3.7 Polling Stations 10

3.8 Ballot Paper Printing 10

3.9 Transport 10

3.10 Recruitment, Training and Deployment of Electoral Officers 11

3.11 Accreditation of Observers and Media Personnel 11

Chapter 4 12

4.1 CONDUCT OF ELECTION – POLLING 12

4.2 Polling 12

4.3 Assisted Voters 12

4.4 Turned Away Voters 12

4.5 Verification and Counting 13

4.6 Results of Poll 13

4.7 The Environment 14

Chapter 5 15

5.1 OBSERVATIONS, RECOMMENDATIONS AND CONCLUSION 15

5.2 Budget 15

5.3 Conclusion 15

Chapter 1

1.1 THE ZIMBABWE ELECTORAL COMMISSION

1.2 Composition

The Zimbabwe Electoral Commission (ZEC) is an Election Management Body (EMB) established in terms of the section 238 of the Constitution of Zimbabwe.

It is composed of a Chairperson appointed by the President after consultation with the Judicial Service Commission and the Committee on Standing Rules and Orders and eight other members appointed by the President from a list of not fewer than twelve nominees submitted by the Committee on Standing Rules and Orders.

At the time of the by-elections, the Commission consisted of a full board of nine members as follows:

1. Honourable Mrs Justice Priscilla Makanyara Chigumba - Chairperson
2. Ambassador Rodney Simukai Kiwa - Deputy Chairperson
3. Mr Jasper Mangwana - Commissioner
4. Mrs Abigail Millicent Mohadi- Ambrose - Commissioner
5. Mr Shepherd Manhivi - Commissioner
6. Ms Catherine Mpofu - Commissioner
7. Mrs Rosewita Murutare - Commissioner
8. Dr Jane Mbetu Nzvenga - Commissioner
9. Dr Kudzai Shava - Commissioner

1.2 Functions of the Commission

The functions of the Zimbabwe Electoral Commission are provided for in section 239 of the Constitution as follows:

a. to prepare for, conduct and supervise –

(i) elections to the office of President and to Parliament;

(ii) elections to provincial and metropolitan councils and the governing bodies of local authorities;

(iii) elections of Members of the National Council of Chiefs established by section 285; and

(iv) referendums;

and to ensure that those elections and referendums are conducted efficiently, freely, fairly, transparently and in accordance with the law,

b. to supervise elections of the President of the Senate and the Speaker and to ensure that these elections are conducted efficiently and in accordance with the law;

c. to register voters;

d. to compile voters' rolls and registers,

e. to ensure the proper custody and maintenance of voters rolls and registers;

f. to delimit constituencies, wards and other electoral boundaries;

g. to design, print and distribute ballot papers, approve the form of and procure ballot boxes, and establish and operate polling centres;

h. to conduct and supervise voter education;

i. to accredit observers of elections and referendums;

j. to give instructions to persons in the employment of the State or of a local authority for the purpose of ensuring the efficient, free, fair, proper and transparent conduct of any election or referendum; and

k. to receive and consider complaints from the public and to take such action in regard to the complaints as it considers appropriate.

1.3 Additional Functions

The Electoral Act [*Chapter 2:13*] in section 5 thereof provides for additional functions and powers of the Commission as follows:

a) undertaking and promoting research into electoral matters
b) developing expertise and the use of technology in regard to the electoral processes; and
c) promoting co-operation between Government, political parties and civil society in regard to elections; and
d) keeping the public informed about -

i. the times and places where persons can register as voters and the progress of the voter registration exercise; and
ii. the delimitation of wards, constituencies and other electoral boundaries, and
iii. the location and boundaries of polling stations and when they are open for inspection; and
iv. voters roll and the times and places at which they are open for inspection; and
v. political parties and candidates contesting every election and;
vi. voting; and
vii. generally, all matters relating to the Commission's work and the electoral process; and

(d1) ensuring that gender is mainstreamed into electoral processes; and

(e) making recommendations to Parliament on appropriate ways to provide public financing for political parties.

Chapter 2

2.1 BUDGET

The Commission incurred expenses amounting to ZWG 12 000 000 for the 2 August 2025 by- elections.

2.2 Budget Control

The Commission applied all financial statutory guidelines in compliance with the law.

Chapter 3

3.1 PREPARATIONS FOR THE BY-ELECTIONS

Following the notification of the local authority vacancies which arose in Ward 14 of Chinhoyi Municipality and Ward 6 of Epworth Local Board, the Commission issued **ZEC Notices** on 13 May and 14 June 2025 respectively calling for by-elections to be held on 2 August 2025. The seats became vacant by reason of the councillors being charged and convicted with the abuse of public office. The Commission duly prepared for the by-elections in the Wards concerned.

3.2 Voter Education

The Commission conducted pre-nomination and pre-polling voter education for the said by-elections during the period 5 to 9 August and 4 to 8 September 2025. The key messages for the pre-nomination phase centred on what had caused the by-elections and who qualified to be a candidate in the elections. The pre-polling voter education emphasised on notifying the electorate on the contesting candidates, correct documentation to carry, the polling date and times, the voting process and how to cast a vote, assisted and redirected voters and encouraging the electorate to go and vote.

The voter education teams used various methodologies to educate the electorate. These included the door-to-door visits, interaction with individuals and addressing of gatherings, use of posters, distribution of pamphlets and flyers and use of the Public Address (PA) System.

3.3 Nomination Court Results

The Nomination Courts sat on the 3rd and 30th of June 2025. The following candidates were nominated for election at the close of the sitting of the said Courts:

Persons Nominated for Election

Local Authority	Ward	Candidate	Se	Sponsoring
Chinhoyi Municipality	14	Solomon Bizwork	M	ZANU PF
		Zimbiri Hope	M	Independent
Epworth Local Board	6	Bushe Civilised	M	ZANU PF
		Nyahunzvi Alice	F	MDC-T
		Nyapetwa Peter	M	Independent

Polling took place on ***Saturday, 2 August 2025*** to elect Councillors for the said wards.

3.4 Voter Registration

No voter registration was conducted prior to the sitting of the nomination courts owing to the fact that according to section 121A (3) of the Electoral Act [Chapter 2:13], the voters' roll closes on the day the vacancy arises for local authority by-elections.

3.5 Provision of voters rolls to Candidates

The contesting candidates were issued with copies of voters' roll for their respective Wards. An analysable electronic voters' roll was placed at respective provincial, district and ward centres for access by the public.

3.6 Multiparty Liaison Committees

An average of two (2) Multiparty Liaison Committee meetings were held in the districts and wards where the by-elections were conducted. The meetings were successfully conducted. All the outstanding issues concerning the conduct of the by-elections were resolved.

3.7 Polling Stations

A total of twenty-five (25) polling stations broken as follows were established in the Wards that had by-elections:-

Ser	Province	District	Local Authority	Ward	No. of Polling Stations
1	Mashonaland West	Makonde	Chinhoyi Municipality	14	**5**
2	Harare Metropolitan	Harare South	Epworth Local Board	6	**20**
Total					**25**

3.8 Ballot Paper Printing

A total of seventeen thousand seven hundred and fifty ballot papers (17 750) were printed for the 2 August 2025 by-elections by the Minting and Printing Company of Zimbabwe (PMCZ). This information was publicised in terms of the law.

3.9 Transport

The Commission used its own vehicle fleet for the by-elections. Each polling station was allocated a vehicle and this made the process of deployment, transmission of results and decamping very smooth.

3.10 Recruitment, Training and Deployment of Electoral Officers

Personnel to conduct the by-elections were drawn from ZEC secretariat, the Civil Service Commission and the local authorities concerned. The recruitment of Ward Elections Officers and their deputies was done on time and same were trained between 24 and 25 July 2025. The training of Presiding Officers was conducted on the 27th and 28th of July 2025 while the Polling Officers were trained between the 30th and 31st of September 2025.



Deployment of electoral officers took place prior to their training sessions. Training of polling officers was done at polling station level. The Zimbabwe Republic Police (ZRP) officers were deployed alongside electoral staff to provide security while the setting up of polling stations and rehearsals were done a day before polling.

3.11 Accreditation of Observers and Media Personnel

The accreditation of observers for the by-elections was conducted during the period 15 May and 2 August 2025. An accreditation team was deployed to each of the two provinces where the by-elections took place.

Chapter 4

4.1 CONDUCT OF ELECTION – POLLING

4.2 Polling

Polling took place on 2 August 2025 commencing from 0700 hours and ending at 1900 hours. Due regard was given to the provision that no voter in the queue of persons waiting to vote as at 1900 hours would be turned away. Every polling station was staffed with electoral officers whose number varied with the voter population. Only one (1) distinctly ballot box was set up in each polling station.

4.3 Assisted Voters

The table below shows the number of persons by gender assisted in the wards during the by-elections: -

Local Authority	**Assisted Voters**		
	Female	Male	Total
Epworth Local Board Ward 6	33	6	39
Chinhoyi Municipality Ward 14	25	7	32
Total	**58**	**13**	**71**

The illiterate, the elderly and the visually challenged voters who were not able to vote without assistance were assisted by persons of their choice in line with the law. A person who did not bring an assistant was assisted by the Presiding Officer in the presence of two other officers and the police officer on duty.

4.4 Turned Away Voters

The two wards had a total of one hundred and sixteen (116) turned away voters broken down as follows: -

Local Authority	**Turned Away Voters**		**Total**
	Female	Male	
Epworth Local Board Ward 6	44	45	89
Chinhoyi Municipality Ward 14	27	26	53
Total	**71**	**71**	**142**

The reasons for turning away voters were the non-possession of identity cards and not appearing on the voters' roll among others.

4.5 Verification and Counting

The counting of the votes was preceded by the verification of ballots which process was administered at polling station level by the Presiding Officers in the presence of candidates and their election agents. The verification and counting of polling station results was completed on 2 August 2025.

4.6 Results of Poll

The Ward Elections Officers declared the results of the poll at their respective Ward Collation Centres. The polling station results were posted outside the polling stations and the collated results at the Ward Collation Centres.

The summary of the results for the by-elections was as follows:

Local Authority	**Ward**	**Candidates**	**Sex**	**Party**	**Votes**	
Epworth Local Board	*6*	*Bushe Civilised*	*M*	*ZANU PF*	*3022*	*Winner*
		Nyahunzvi Alice	F	MDC-T	120	
		Nyapetwa Peter	M	Independent	***23***	
		Total Valid Votes Cast			***3165***	
		Total Votes Rejected			**25**	
		Ballot Paper Unaccounted for			**0**	
		Total Votes Cast			**3190**	
		Voter Population			**12382**	
		Percentage Poll			**25,8%**	
Chinhoyi Municipality	*14*	*Solomon Bizwork*	*M*	*ZANU PF*	*599*	*Winner*
		Zimbiri Hope	M	Independent	**194**	
		Total Valid Votes Cast			**793**	
		Total Votes Rejected			**14**	
		Ballot Paper Unaccounted for			**0**	
		Total Votes Cast			**807**	
		Voter Population			**2340**	
		Percentage Poll			**34,5%**	

Comparison of 2023 Harmonised Elections and 2025 By-elections Voter Turn-out

		Voter Population		Percentage Poll	
Local Authority	**Ward**	**2023**	**2025**	**2023**	**2025**
Chinhoyi Municipality	14	2 349	2 340	71.7%	34.5%
Epworth Local Board	6	12 411	12 382	61.3%	25.8%

4.7 The Environment

The elections were held under calm and peaceful conditions. The Commission did not receive any report on politically motivated incidents.

Chapter 5

5.1 OBSERVATIONS, RECOMMENDATIONS AND CONCLUSION

The Commission made a number of observations and recommendations as presented below.

5.2 Budget

Observation

There is a notable difference between the budgetary requirements and the amounts released by Treasury.

Recommendation

Adequate and timeous funding is critical in the implementation of polling processes. There is need for partial payment of allowances in foreign currency to cushion electoral officers.

5.3 Conclusion

Generally, the 2 August 2025 by-elections were conducted in a peaceful manner. The Commission consulted and worked in collaboration with its stakeholders throughout the election period ensuring that the process was inclusive and transparent.

The Commission was satisfied that the 2 August 2025 by-elections were conducted in a manner and under conditions that allowed voters to freely express their will.

Signed: ……. Date: ……....

Mrs Justice Priscilla Makanyara Chigumba

ZEC Chairperson

ZIMBABWE ELECTORAL COMMISSION

ZEC Head Office
Mahachi Quantum Building
1 Nelson Mandela Avenue
P. Bag 7782 Harare Zimbabwe
Phone : +263-242-756252/ 759130/
774095
Email :inquiries@zec.org.zw